All that said, I don't think there is a dramatic difference in how long one version or the other version took. I've been working with these samples for a long time, and they aren't *that* big, and the underlying logic mostly transferred. The Hotwire translation probably took less time but not, like, an order of magnitude or anything like that. I do think, and this is based on other experience with larger codebases, that the React version would be more challenging and would grow in complexity faster going forward.

The two systems have a different model of how they work. In Hotwire, the more you can think of things as basically regular HTTP requests with special processing of an HTML response, the easier things get. In React, you're more likely to think in terms of changing internal client-side data with the HTTP requests and even think of the HTML markup as kind of a side effect of changing state.

React has a way of relating presentation and domain logic, that means you can do a lot of work within the domain logic and the presentation will just automatically change. So the last step of making things work in React is very satisfying. It also means that basically Hotwire is letting you take a shortcut for simple interactions that don't require a lot of domain logic. As the Hotwire logic becomes more complex, you might wind up building in the domain logic and reactivity that React gives you. Still, there's a long way to go before the Hotwire bit becomes as verbose as a simple React app.

Here's a tour of both apps. I'm going to show each one fully formed rather than walking through the individual steps. I'm also not going to show all the code changes, just the important or interesting ones. You can see the full apps in the sample code directory as appendix_hotwire/01 or appendex_react/01.